

Outleads Inc. v. Salesforce Inc.

Public Outleads materials describe linking online interactions and tracking identifiers to later CRM, call-center, marketing, analytics, or advertising records. The preliminary issue map focuses on identity resolution, data ingestion, transformation, provenance, schema mapping, and attribution workflows.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-26	U.S. District Court for the Eastern District of Virginia	1:26-cv-02783	Patent Infringement

Prepared 2026-08-27. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION

Outleads Inc. v. Salesforce Inc.

FORUM / DOCKET

U.S. District Court for the Eastern District of Virginia / 1:26-cv-02783

FILED / TYPE

2026-08-26 / patent infringement

PUBLIC DOCKET[Open docket](#)**VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD**

The CourtListener docket search and the public RECAP copy identify Outleads Inc. v. Salesforce Inc., No. 1:26-cv-02783, in the Eastern District of Virginia, with a complaint filed August 26, 2026. The complaint is the primary source for the asserted patents, claim language, accused products, and counsel signatures; this preliminary record does not substitute a claim-by-claim reading of that filing.

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Elliot C. Cook - Partner, Finnegan, Henderson, Farabow, Garrett & Dunner LLP. Verified docket fact: Cook is listed as plaintiff counsel on the filed complaint. His official professional profile identifies an active patent-litigation and post-grant practice, making him an appropriate attorney account for a preliminary expert-search packet.

elliott.cook@finnegan.com - publicly printed in the [linked professional source](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

Public Outleads materials describe linking online interactions and tracking identifiers to later CRM, call-center, marketing, analytics, or advertising records. The preliminary issue map focuses on identity resolution, data ingestion, transformation, provenance, schema mapping, and attribution workflows.

Secondary-source limitation: The complaint and patent record must control. Public product materials do not establish the operation of any accused Salesforce implementation, customer configuration, source code, or claim-by-claim mapping. [Open public synopsis](#)

REPORTED ASSERTED PATENTS

[U.S. Patent No. 12,363,061](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 Identity resolution across online and offline records

What identifier, cookie value, form value, telephone-event value, or other key links a website interaction to a later CRM, call-center, or marketing record, and how reliably does that linkage occur?

Potential evidence: Claim language, implementation architecture, event schemas, identifier-generation code, browser and server logs, CRM records, and controlled end-to-end tests.

02 Data ingestion and transformation

Does the accused system receive offline or third-party records, transform them into the claimed format, and transmit the resulting data to an analytics or advertising platform?

Potential evidence: API specifications, connector configuration, ETL or workflow code, message queues, field mappings, audit logs, and integration test records.

03 Event attribution and temporal ordering

Can a later conversion, agent disposition, revenue entry, or other offline event be associated with the original online visit in the manner required by the asserted claims?

Potential evidence: Timestamped event logs, analytics-event payloads, CRM change history, cookie and session handling, retry behavior, and reproducible trace analysis.

04 Source-system responsibility

Which component performs each claimed function: browser script, web server, Salesforce product, integration middleware, customer configuration, or a third-party analytics and advertising platform?

Potential evidence: Deployment diagrams, source code, product documentation, configuration records, APIs, network traces, and testimony from system architects.

Questions likely to require expert input

05 Schema mapping and record semantics

Do fields transferred between the CRM and analytics systems have the claimed semantic relationship, including whether they preserve the same user, visit, communication, or conversion record?

Potential evidence: Data dictionaries, mapping rules, transformation code, sample payloads, database schemas, provenance records, and customer implementation materials.

06 Automated versus user-configured operation

Which alleged steps are performed automatically by software, and which depend on administrator configuration, manual tagging, customer workflow, or optional third-party tooling?

Potential evidence: Default settings, product guides, onboarding materials, configuration screens, feature flags, training records, and usage telemetry.

07 Historical technical baseline

What did a person of ordinary skill understand at the relevant priority dates about web analytics, cookies, CRM connectors, conversion tracking, event APIs, and online-to-offline attribution?

Potential evidence: Contemporaneous platform documentation, standards, product manuals, academic papers, open-source software, patent literature, and a defensible POSITA definition.

08 Technical value and alternatives

What technical value, if any, is supplied by the asserted identifier-and-record integration rather than by surrounding CRM, analytics, advertising, and customer-workflow features; and what noninfringing designs were technically feasible?

Potential evidence: Feature-use data, architecture alternatives, engineering records, performance and reliability testing, product roadmaps, and technical apportionment analysis.

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 H. V. Jagadish, PhD

Bernard A. Galler Collegiate Professor of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science, University of Michigan

TECHNICAL FIT

Direct fit for heterogeneous-data integration, data modeling, querying, provenance, and entity linkage across enterprise systems.

RELEVANT WORK

His University of Michigan materials describe research in databases, data management, and integration of heterogeneous information; his work includes the widely cited Clio data-exchange and schema-mapping line of research.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Academic research focus is broader than any particular Salesforce product or deployment. Prior opinions, funding, consulting, and conflicts require matter-specific diligence.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | jag@umich.edu | [public email source](#)

02 Juliana Freire, PhD

Professor of Computer Science and Engineering, New York University

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for data provenance, workflow reproducibility, data transformation, and determining how information moves through multi-step data systems.

RELEVANT WORK

Her NYU profile describes research on data management, visualization, and reproducibility; her published work includes provenance and workflow systems for complex data analysis.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Best fit is provenance and workflow analysis rather than CRM product architecture. Standard prior-opinion and relationship diligence remains necessary.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | juliana.freire@nyu.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Michael Cafarella, PhD

Professor of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science, Massachusetts Institute of Technology

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for data extraction, data integration, semi-structured web data, and large-scale systems that map varied inputs into structured records.

RELEVANT WORK

His public materials describe work on web-scale information extraction, data integration, and the early Hadoop ecosystem, including the NELL knowledge-extraction project.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The cited university page should be refreshed for current institutional-title confirmation before outreach or retention. His work is less narrowly directed to advertising-tech attribution.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | michjc@csail.mit.edu | [public email source](#)

04 Alin Deutsch, PhD

Professor of Computer Science and Engineering, University of California San Diego

TECHNICAL FIT

Direct fit for data exchange, query reformulation, schema mappings, and determining whether an implementation transforms and carries records as claimed.

RELEVANT WORK

His UC San Diego profile describes research in databases, data exchange, information integration, query optimization, and provenance.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Particularly technical database-theory profile may need pairing with a practitioner for product-specific CRM implementation evidence.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | abdeutsch@ucsd.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Craig A. Knoblock, PhD

Research Professor and Director, Information Sciences Institute, University of Southern California

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for data-source modeling, information integration, entity resolution, and extraction from diverse operational systems.

RELEVANT WORK

His USC profile describes work in information integration, data extraction, geospatial data, and automated construction of data-integration systems.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Some work centers on geospatial and web-data systems, so the specific CRM and analytics application must be assessed during diligence.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | knoblock@isi.edu | [public email source](#)

06 Zachary G. Ives, PhD

Adani President's Distinguished Professor, University of Pennsylvania

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for database systems, data integration, provenance, data cleaning, and workflow behavior in enterprise information systems.

RELEVANT WORK

The Penn Database Group identifies Ives as a faculty contact; his work includes ORCHESTRA data sharing and provenance, data integration, and database systems research.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

A primarily academic database-systems perspective may need supplementation for a particular accused product's implementation and customer configuration.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | zives@seas.upenn.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 Jennifer Widom, PhD

Professor of Computer Science, Stanford University

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for data management, semi-structured data, event processing, data lineage, and workflow semantics.

RELEVANT WORK

Her Stanford profile describes pioneering database research, including active databases, data streams, semi-structured data, and data provenance.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

High-profile academic and leadership commitments may affect practical fit or time; current role and availability must be confirmed without presuming either.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | widom@stanford.edu | [public email source](#)

08 Aditya G. Parameswaran, PhD

Associate Professor of Electrical Engineering and Computer Sciences, University of California, Berkeley

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for interactive data systems, data wrangling, transformations, and reproducible analysis workflows.

RELEVANT WORK

His Berkeley profile describes work on data management and human-in-the-loop data systems; he founded and led research associated with the Data Interaction Group.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Best fit for data workflow and transformation questions rather than attribution-adtech practice or Salesforce-specific engineering.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | adityagp@eecs.berkeley.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Eugene Wu, PhD

Associate Professor of Computer Science, Columbia University

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for data lineage, data cleaning, debugging of data pipelines, and causal analysis of transformations in operational data workflows.

RELEVANT WORK

His Columbia materials describe the Columbia Data Systems Laboratory's work on data management, provenance, visualization, and debugging complex data-analysis workflows.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

A current-title check and inquiry into any industry relationships are prudent. The public profile emphasizes modern data systems more than legacy web-analytics products.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | ewu@cs.columbia.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Kevin C.-C. Chang, PhD

Professor of Computer Science, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for information access, structured and semi-structured integration, web data, extraction, and semantic matching between records.

RELEVANT WORK

His Illinois profile describes work on information integration, web and text data management, information extraction, and data-driven applications.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The fit is strongest for integration and information-access issues, not necessarily the operational details of a specific CRM connector; industry ties and prior opinions require review.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | kcchang@illinois.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?type=r&q=1%3A26-cv-02783>

Public professional email source: <https://www.finnegan.com/en/professionals/elliott-c-cook.html>

Public technical context source: <https://www.outleads.com/call-tracking-analytics>

LIMITATIONS

The complaint and patent record must control. Public product materials do not establish the operation of any accused Salesforce implementation, customer configuration, source code, or claim-by-claim mapping.

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